



American black bear: this bear sleeps up to six months during winter.



Sloth bear: its claws grow up to 8 cm (3 in) long, and help it tear open ant nests.



Giant panda: this black-and-white bear mostly lives by itself.



Sun bear: it uses its 25-cm- (10-in-) long tongue to suck honey out of trees.



Asiatic black bear: this very rare bear is a protected species.

Climbing bears

Bears normally walk slowly, but if they feel the need they can gallop at very high speeds.

It may seem unlikely because of their size, but most bears are also able to climb trees. This giant panda is climbing a tree to find a safe place to rest.

The giant panda eats mostly bamboo shoots. It will sometimes eat small animal grubs if it can find them.



Water bears

Polar bears live in the Arctic. They have thick fur to keep them warm in the chilly weather. They are excellent swimmers and can hold their breath for up to two minutes underwater.



Mother love

The mother bear looks after her cubs fiercely during their first year, teaching them how to survive. She sometimes stands on her back legs to increase her height and frighten enemies away.

